

Payment Terms, Billing & Subscription Policy

Acme Commerce Inc. | Effective: January 1, 2025 | Version 2.0

1. Introduction

This Payment Terms, Billing & Subscription Policy (“Policy”) governs all payments, billing cycles, subscription renewals, and financial obligations associated with purchases made from Acme Commerce Inc. It applies to one-time purchases, subscriptions, pre-orders, and B2B accounts. This Policy is incorporated into our Terms of Service.

2. Accepted Payment Methods

Method	Regions	Notes
Visa / Mastercard	Global	3-D Secure enabled
American Express	US, CA, UK, EU	No additional surcharge
Discover	US only	—
PayPal	Global	Buyer protection applies
Apple Pay / Google Pay	Supported regions	Tokenized card
Bank Transfer (ACH / SEPA)	US, EU	Orders over \$500 only
Wire Transfer	Global	Orders over \$5,000 only
Acme Gift Card / Store Credit	Global	Non-refundable to cash

3. Currency, Pricing & Taxes

- All prices are displayed in **USD** unless a localized currency is selected at checkout.
- Sales tax / VAT is calculated based on the shipping destination and applied at checkout.
- International customers are responsible for customs duties, import taxes, and brokerage fees.
- Prices are subject to change without notice; the price at checkout governs your order.
- Promotional pricing cannot be applied retroactively to prior orders.

4. Authorization & Capture

When you place an order, we place an authorization hold on your payment method. This is a temporary hold, not a charge. The hold is **captured (charged) when the item ships**. Multi-item orders may be captured in multiple partial charges as items ship separately.

Event	Timing	Card Impact
Order placed	Immediate	Authorization hold (1–3 days)

Event	Timing	Card Impact
Item ships	Ship date	Charge captured
Pre-order	1–2 days before release	Charge captured
Backorder	When stock arrives	Authorization may expire; re-auth
Cancelled order	Within 24 hours	Hold released

5. Subscription Plans & Billing Cycles

5.1 Available Plans

Plan	Billing Frequency	Discount	Renewal
Monthly	Every 30 days	—	Auto-renews
Quarterly	Every 90 days	5% off	Auto-renews
Annual	Every 365 days	15% off	Auto-renews
Lifetime (limited)	One-time	—	No renewal

5.2 Renewal & Notification

- Subscriptions auto-renew on the same calendar day each cycle.
- We send a renewal reminder email 7 days before each charge.
- You may cancel anytime from Account → Subscription → Cancel.
- Cancellation stops future charges; the current period remains active.

5.3 Plan Changes & Upgrades

Upgrades take effect immediately with a prorated charge. Downgrades take effect at the next billing cycle. Pausing a subscription is available for up to 90 days.

6. Failed Payments & Dunning

If a payment fails, we retry up to **3 times** over a 7-day window (days 0, 3, and 7). You will receive email reminders before each retry. If all retries fail:

- The subscription is paused and premium features are suspended.
- A final notice is sent with a 14-day grace period.
- After 30 days of non-payment, the account may be archived.
- Outstanding balances may be sent to a collection agency after 90 days.

7. Cancellations & Refunds on Subscriptions

Scenario	Refund Policy
Monthly plan cancelled mid-cycle	No prorated refund

Scenario	Refund Policy
Annual plan cancelled within 14 days	Full refund if unused
Annual plan cancelled after 14 days	Prorated store credit
Lifetime plan cancelled	Non-refundable
Free trial cancelled before end	No charge
Free trial not cancelled	Charged full subscription price

8. Chargebacks & Payment Disputes

Please contact us before initiating a chargeback so we can resolve the issue directly. Chargebacks filed without prior contact may result in account suspension, cancellation of pending orders, and recovery of the disputed amount plus a \$25 administrative fee where permitted by law. Fraudulent chargebacks may be reported to the relevant authorities.

9. Payment Security & PCI Compliance

- All transactions are encrypted via TLS 1.3.
- We are PCI-DSS Level 1 compliant through our payment partners.
- Full card numbers are never stored on Acme servers.
- Card data is tokenized for one-click checkout.
- Fraud screening uses ML models and 3-D Secure where available.

10. B2B / NET Terms

Approved business accounts may qualify for NET-30 or NET-60 terms. Approval requires a credit check and a signed master service agreement. Late payments accrue interest at 1.5% per month (or the maximum permitted by law). Acme may suspend B2B accounts with overdue balances.

11. Taxes & Exemptions

- US sales tax is collected in states where Acme has economic nexus.
- EU/UK VAT is collected for B2C customers under OSS/IOSS rules.
- Tax-exempt organizations may submit certificates to tax@acme-commerce.example.
- VAT invoices are available for download in Account → Billing → Invoices.

12. Invoices & Billing Records

Every successful charge generates an invoice accessible under Account → Billing. Invoices include itemized products, tax breakdown, shipping, and discounts. You may request consolidated invoices for B2B accounts at no cost.

13. Promotions, Coupons & Credits

- Coupons cannot be combined unless explicitly stated.
- Store credit never expires and can be combined with promotions.
- Gift cards are non-refundable and non-transferable.
- Referral credits are issued 30 days after the referee's first order ships.

14. Anti-Fraud Measures

We use a combination of address verification (AVS), CVV checks, device fingerprinting, and behavioral analytics to detect fraud. Orders flagged by our system may be held pending verification and may require additional documentation. Acme reserves the right to refuse or cancel any order suspected of fraud.

15. Governing Law & Disputes

This Policy is governed by the laws of the State of Delaware, USA, without regard to conflict of law principles. Disputes will be resolved by binding arbitration in Wilmington, Delaware, except where prohibited by local law. Small-claims court actions are permitted.

16. Contact & Appendix

Billing Support: **billing@acme-commerce.example**

Payments Team: **payments@acme-commerce.example**

Tax Team: **tax@acme-commerce.example**

Phone: +1 (800) 555-0143 (Mon–Fri 9:00–18:00 EST)

Appendix A — Billing Glossary

Term	Definition
Authorization	A temporary hold placed on a card to verify funds.
Capture	The actual transfer of funds from the card to the merchant.
Dunning	The process of retrying and notifying about failed payments.
Proration	Charging or crediting a partial amount for a partial period.
Chargeback	A forced reversal of a charge initiated by the cardholder's bank.
NET-30	Payment due 30 days after the invoice date.
AVS	Address Verification System — checks billing address against the card issuer.

This Policy may be updated; material changes will be announced 14 days in advance. The version in effect at the time of your purchase or renewal governs that transaction.